

The LITTLE princess

Life for a royal baby was not the same as in most families. The princess was cared for mainly by nursery staff, led by Clara Knight.

Clara Knight was a farmer's daughter who became a nanny for the family. Though not married, she was always called Mrs. Knight by grown-ups and "Alla" by the children she took care of. The Duchess trusted Nanny Alla to look after baby Elizabeth. Women in high society, like the Duchess, did not spend all day, every day, with small children, no matter how much they loved them. In those days, the nanny was in charge. Nanny Alla made strict rules for the young Elizabeth to follow.

What is a nanny?

A nanny is someone who is paid to look after young children, and who sometimes lives with the family.